

Blackstone's \$618B AUM Tops IRE Ranking as Top 50 Managers Hit \$4.8T

\$618 billion

Assets under management

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What \$618 billion reveals

\$618 billion

Assets under management

\$4.8 trillion

Key figure

\$4.4 trillion

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The top 50 managers collectively hold \$4.8 trillion in real estate AUM, up from \$4.4 trillion the prior year. Among comparable year-over-year respondents, AUM grew 9 percent. The entire universe of firms in the guide tops \$5.8 trillion.

North America remains the dominant region, representing 64 percent of geographically

North America remains the dominant region, representing 64 percent of geographically identified assets. EMEA and Asia Pacific also posted meaningful gains, though the concentration of capital in U.S. markets persists.

Growth is not uniform

Growth is not uniform. The 9 percent aggregate gain masks divergence between the largest institutional platforms and smaller managers. Blackstone alone accounts for roughly 13 percent of the top 50 total. Scale begets scale in fundraising, co-investment access, and fee compression tolerance.

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Interest rates remain the top concern, flagged by 85 percent of respondents. That is nearly universal. Geopolitical risk surged to the second-highest ranking, though the survey did not specify which geopolitical flashpoints managers are watching most closely.

Floating-rate debt on transitional assets continues to pressure cash flows

The rate concern is rational. The Federal Reserve held its benchmark rate at 4.25-4.50 percent through May 2026. The 10-year Treasury yield has oscillated between 4.0 and 4.5 percent for 18 months. Floating-rate debt on transitional assets continues to pressure cash flows.

Managers with locked-in low-cost debt and long-duration leases are insulated

Managers with locked-in low-cost debt and long-duration leases are insulated. Those with near-term maturities on value-add or opportunistic strategies face a different reality. The 9 percent AUM growth figure does not distinguish between capital raised and capital deployed.

Prequin data from Q1 2026 shows \$420 billion in uncommitted real estate capital globally

Dry powder remains elevated. Prequin data from Q1 2026 shows \$420 billion in uncommitted real estate capital globally. The gap between fundraising success and deployment velocity is widening. Managers are sitting on record commitments while waiting for price discovery.

The IRE ranking captures size, not performance

The IRE ranking captures size, not performance. AUM growth can come from new fund closes, asset appreciation, or acquisitions. It can also come from recycling capital into new vehicles while legacy funds underperform. The guide does not disclose net returns, IRRs, or distribution rates.

Institutional investors are increasingly asking those questions

Institutional investors are increasingly asking those questions. CalPERS, CalSTRS, and the Canada Pension Plan Investment Board have all signaled a shift toward co-investments and separate accounts, where fees are lower and transparency is higher. The largest managers are adapting by offering bespoke mandates.

Why it matters

The 9 percent growth rate among comparable firms suggests that capital is flowing to the largest platforms.

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